



Growfit Sports Academy NPC

Grassroots football · U12 · U15 · U17 · Greater Durban, KwaZulu-Natal

FUNDING PROPOSAL · OCTOBER 2026

Growfit Match Video Programme

An AI match camera for a Durban grassroots academy, bought once with no subscription. Every Growfit match is filmed and used to coach our players. A small filming service for families and partner clubs covers the running costs from the first season.

R29,700

Total funding requested: camera, accessories and the first 12 months of running costs

~70

Matches filmed per season across three age groups

R4,800

Yearly running cost after Year 1. No subscription.

Contact

Buhle Madlala, Founder & Academy Director
Khaya Madlala, Fundraising & Registration
[email] · [phone]

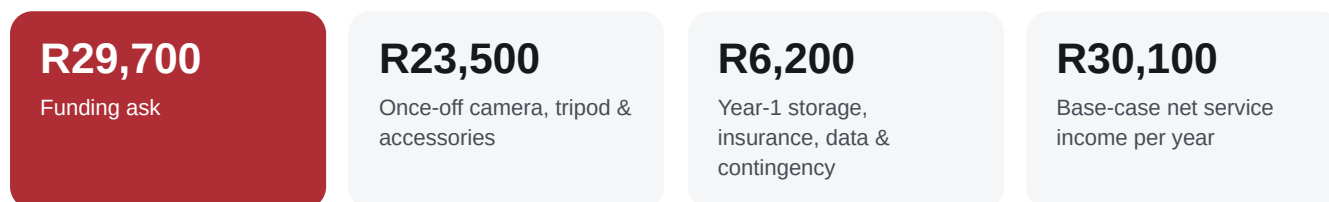
Organisation

Growfit Sports Academy NPC (est. 2023)
NPC Reg. No. [] · PBO No. []
Member club, Greater Durban Football League (GDFL)

1 Executive summary

Professional academies use match video every week to show players what they did and how to do it better. Grassroots players in Greater Durban almost never see themselves play. Most GDFL clubs are run by volunteers and have no video at all.

Growfit Sports Academy is a non-profit academy running U12, U15 and U17 squads, now in its third year. We are asking for **R29,700** to buy an **XbotGo Falcon** AI sports camera and cover its first year of running costs. The camera stands on a tripod at the halfway line, follows the play on its own and records in 4K. Highlights are created automatically. There is **no subscription**: once the camera is bought, it costs only about R4,800 a year to run.



What the funding achieves

- **Player development:** every Growfit match is filmed and reviewed by coaches. Short clips are used at Wednesday and Friday training, so 60-odd players learn from their own games.
- **Visibility for talent:** players whose parents have given media consent get highlight reels, which can support high-school sport scholarships and trials.
- **Raising the level of the league:** opposition clubs can buy the recording of their own match, giving other Durban clubs access to video for the first time.
- **Sustainability from the first season:** a priced filming service is projected to cover the running costs **6 times over in the base case**. Even the conservative case covers running costs and a fund to replace the camera.

Why a low-cost, owned camera. Premium systems such as Veo add statistics and automatic per-player reels, but they cost R70,000–R85,000 in the first year and R30,000–R45,000 every year after that. For a three-volunteer academy, a camera we own outright with almost no running costs is the safer first step. Any surplus is saved toward a premium system later (Section 8). The camera would then remain as a second camera.

2 About Growfit Sports Academy

Growfit Sports Academy is a registered Non-Profit Company founded in 2023 in Greater Durban. It runs three competitive age groups (U12, U15 and U17) in the Greater Durban Football League. Teams train on Wednesdays and Fridays and play on Sundays.

Leadership

Buhle Madlala	Founder, Academy & Technical Director, Finance; coaches across all divisions
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Sphe Mlotshwa	Head Coach [division]; Admin & Equipment Manager
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Khaya Madlala	Head Coach [division]; Fundraising & Registration
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Open seats being recruited: Safeguarding Officer, Programmes & Camps Coordinator, Logistics Coordinator.

Governance already in place

- 8 adopted policies, including Child Protection & Safeguarding (Children's Act 38 of 2005), Discipline, Injury & Medical, Attendance and Social Media
- 6-document registration pack per player per season, including **POPIA and photo/media consent**
- SAFA / GDFL registration for every player; CPR Part B checks for coaches

How we run the academy today

Coaches mark attendance at every session, and a player who drops below 75% gets a welfare check-in. Development is tracked across five areas: technical, tactical, physical, mental and leadership. Every player's consent forms are kept on file, and the video programme uses those same consent records (Section 9), so footage follows the same safeguarding rules as the rest of the player data.

3 The need

For players

Players learn faster when they see what happened. Right now, feedback after a game depends on what a coach remembers from the touchline. Video turns "keep your shape" into a clip the player can watch.

For families

High-school sports programmes and scouts increasingly ask for footage. Families in our community can't pay for private filming, so talented players stay unseen.

For the league

Most GDFL clubs have no video. A shared camera service lets the clubs we play against use their own match footage for coaching.

The barrier

The barrier is money, not interest. Subscription-based AI cameras cost a volunteer club more each year than it can raise. A camera bought once, with no subscription, removes that ongoing cost.

4 The solution: XbotGo Falcon

The XbotGo Falcon is an all-in-one AI sports camera designed for youth and amateur team sports. It is sold in South Africa through a local retailer, with a one-year warranty.

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES FOR GROWFIT
AI auto-tracking	Two lenses: a 106° wide-angle lens follows the ball and players, and a second lens records the play. The camera pans and zooms on its own, so no one needs to operate it during the match.
Video quality	Records in 4K at 30 frames per second, or 1080p at 60 frames per second. Stored on a memory card (up to 1 TB).
Automatic highlights	The XbotGo app detects goals and key moments and puts them into short highlight clips. Coaches can also cut and edit clips in the app.
Live streaming	Can stream to YouTube or Facebook at no extra cost. Used only for events where the organiser takes responsibility for consent (Section 9).
Built for the touchline	About 4 hours of battery, splash-resistant (IPX5), weighs 815 g. The Elite Pack includes a 4 m (13 ft) tripod, the height recommended for 11-a-side pitches.
No subscription	Recording, tracking, highlights and streaming are all included in the purchase price, with 20 GB of XbotGo cloud storage.

How the camera is used in a normal week

SUNDAY Record Tripod set up at the halfway line, 1–3 m behind the touchline. The camera runs for each match at the venue.	SUN NIGHT Offload Footage copied from the memory card to the academy's cloud folder, then checked.	MONDAY Review Coaches watch their squad's match, cut 2–3 clips and note coaching points.	WED · FRI Coach 5–10 minute clip reviews at training, then drills that work on what the clips showed.	MON–TUE Share Opposition clubs and consented parents receive their footage by private link.
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Honest limits, and how we handle them

LIMIT	OUR APPROACH
On full-size 11-a-side pitches, reviewers report the camera can stay zoomed out too wide, with no manual zoom override.	Mount at the full recommended 4 m height at the halfway line. Test in the two-month pilot. The 4K recording lets coaches zoom in when reviewing. U12 games on smaller 9-a-side pitches are less affected.
It records only where the camera points, so off-ball movement can be missed.	Coaching focus is on clear, on-ball moments: pressing, build-up and set pieces. This suits our age groups.
No automatic match statistics or per-player reels.	Coaches record key events by hand. Player reels are edited by hand, so fewer are offered (Section 6).
Footage is on a memory card, not in a managed cloud.	Offloaded the same night to an academy-controlled cloud folder with restricted access, and deleted on a fixed schedule (Section 9).

5 How the programme is run

The programme runs on the XbotGo app, an academy cloud folder and a few simple records. Each task has a named owner, so the work fits around three volunteer coaches.

TASK	HOW IT IS DONE	OWNER
Match-day recording	Camera and tripod collected from the Equipment Manager, set up before kick-off, left running for the matches at that venue, and returned in its locked case. A one-page checklist covers setup, battery and memory card.	Equipment Manager / duty coach
Offload & storage	Same night: footage copied to the academy cloud folder in a fixed folder structure (date / age group / opponent). The card is cleared only after the copy is checked.	Duty coach
Coach review	Each head coach reviews their squad's match, cuts 2–3 clips and notes coaching points for training.	Head coach per age group
Consent register	A register built from the season's registration forms shows each player's photo/media consent status. It is checked before any clip or reel of a player is shared.	Registration lead
Sharing	Private, expiring download links sent to the opposition club contact or to the parent of that child only. Nothing is posted in group chats.	Head coach / Admin Manager
Orders & money	An order register records the club or family, the match, whether the agreement is signed, and payment (EFT / SnapScan). Footage is released only when both are in place. Reported to the funder each quarter.	Admin Manager / Finance

6 Budget

The camera is bought from a South African retailer in rand, so there are no import or exchange-rate costs. Prices will be confirmed with a formal quote before purchase, and any saving reduces the amount requested.

ITEM	BASIS	ZAR
Once-off: equipment		
XbotGo Falcon Elite Pack	Camera, 4 m NT4 tripod, carrying case; local retail	21,000
Accessories	512 GB memory card, card reader, power bank, rain cover, tripod lock	2,500
Subtotal once-off		23,500
Year 1: running costs		
Cloud storage for footage	2 TB plan, 12 months	2,400
Portable-equipment insurance	All-risk, estimate	1,200
Mobile data	Sharing and backup uploads	1,200
Contingency	5%	1,400
Subtotal Year 1 running		6,200
Total funding requested		R29,700

7 Service & income model

The service exists to keep the camera running and to save toward replacing or upgrading it. Prices are set for grassroots clubs and families, and every income stream follows the consent rules in Section 9.

STREAM	OFFER	PRICE	WHO IT'S FOR / SAFEGUARD
1. Club match footage	Full-match video (MP4) by private download link, with automatic goal highlights.	R300	The opposition club only, after signing a footage-sharing agreement confirming it holds its own players' media consent.
2. Player highlight packages	Hand-cut clips of the player from the term's matches, or an edited season "showcase reel" for trials and school applications.	R300 / term R800 / season	Growfit players only, and only where media consent is on file.
3. Filming service	Camera and volunteer operator for school matches, friendlies and holiday tournaments. Optional live stream.	R900 / match R2,500 / day	The organising club or school, which is responsible for consent at its event.
4. Community sponsor	"Growfit Match Cam, supported by [Sponsor]": logo on highlight reels, social posts and the tripod banner.	R6,000+ / year	Local business. The sponsor's branding never appears next to an individual child's name.

Key assumptions

ASSUMPTION	CONSERVATIVE	BASE	STRONG
Active match months per year	9	9	9
Growfit matches filmed per month (one camera, three squads)	6	8	9
Opposition clubs that buy footage	15%	25%	35%
Average footage price	R300	R300	R350
Families buying a term package (of ~60 players)	4	6	10
Season showcase reels sold	2	4	6
External filming jobs per month / tournament days per year	0.5 / 1	1 / 2	1.5 / 3
Sponsorship per year	R0	R6,000	R10,000

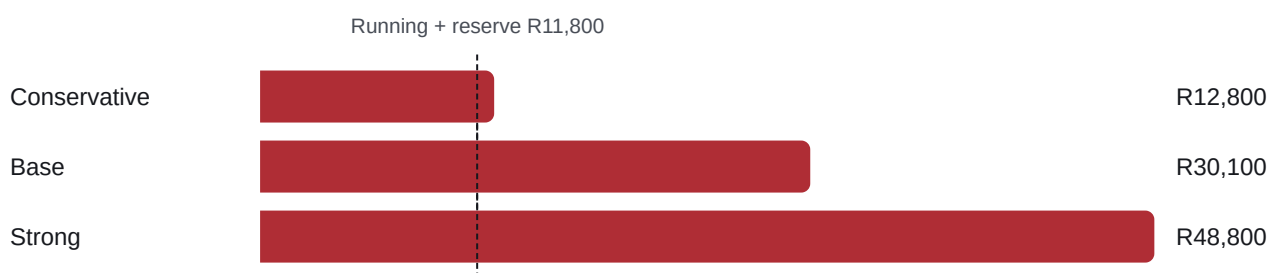
Player numbers and fixture counts are planning assumptions and will be confirmed against the 2027 GDFL fixture list and registrations.

8 Financial projections

The grant covers the camera and the first year of running costs. From Year 2, service income has to pay for two things: the **running cost of R4,800** a year, and a **replacement reserve of R7,000** a year, so the camera can be replaced after about three seasons. Whatever is left goes into an upgrade fund.

ANNUAL FIGURES (ZAR)	CONSERVATIVE	BASE	STRONG
1. Club match footage	2,400	5,400	9,900
2. Player highlight packages	5,200	8,600	13,800
3. Filming service	6,600	13,100	19,600
4. Community sponsor	0	6,000	10,000
Gross service income	14,200	33,100	53,300
Less payment fees (3%)	(400)	(1,000)	(1,600)
Less operator stipends (external jobs)	(1,000)	(2,000)	(2,900)
Net service income	12,800	30,100	48,800
Less running cost (from Year 2)	(4,800)	(4,800)	(4,800)
Less camera replacement reserve	(7,000)	(7,000)	(7,000)
Annual surplus to upgrade fund	R1,000	R18,300	R37,000

Net service income vs. yearly running cost and replacement reserve



Bars: net service income per year (ZAR). Dashed line: yearly running cost plus camera replacement reserve.

What the surplus is for

- **A second camera.** With one camera, matches at different venues on the same Sunday can't all be filmed. In the base case, a second camera can be paid for from the upgrade fund within about 18 months.
- **A later upgrade.** Once demand is proven, the fund can go toward a premium system with automatic statistics and player reels. The Falcon would stay on as the second camera.

Growfit's NPC status: service income is used only for the programme. Tax treatment of trading income (including the partial exemption for public benefit organisations) will be confirmed with our accountant before the service launches.

9 Child protection, POPIA & consent

Every player we film is a child. Under POPIA (sections 34–35), children's personal information, including identifiable video, may only be processed with the consent of a parent or guardian, or under a narrow legal exception. Because Growfit stores its own footage, the academy is directly responsible for keeping it secure.

RULE	HOW IT IS APPLIED
Consent before footage is used	Growfit's registration pack already includes POPIA and photo/media consent. Clips and reels are only created and shared for players with consent on file, checked against the consent register before anything is shared.
Opposition players	Opposition footage goes only to the opposition club, for its own players. The club signs a short <i>Footage Sharing Agreement</i> confirming it holds media consent and will not publish the footage. We do not sell individual reels of opposition players.
League & venue notice	The GDFL is informed before launch. Pre-match notice to the opponent and a sign at the venue that filming is taking place. A match is not filmed if the league or the opposition objects.
Secure storage	Footage is kept in one academy-controlled cloud folder, with access limited to coaches. Memory cards are cleared after offload, and personal phones are not used for storage. Download links are private and expire.
Live streaming	Growfit's own U12–U17 league matches are not streamed publicly. A stream is only run for an event whose organiser has confirmed consent, and as an unlisted stream unless agreed otherwise.
Retention & deletion	Full matches are kept for 12 months, then deleted unless needed for safeguarding. Parents can ask for their child's clips to be removed at any time.
Safeguarding	Camera handled only by vetted adults (CPR Part B checked). Recording is only of matches and training, never in changing rooms. The incoming Safeguarding Officer will be the named lead for video.
Information Officer	The Academy Director serves as Information Officer and will be registered with the Information Regulator before launch. Where the cloud storage is outside South Africa, this is disclosed in the consent form.

10 Risks & mitigation

RISK	MITIGATION
Theft or damage	Camera always stays with a named adult and goes in a locked case between games. Tripod is tethered and weighted, and insurance is included in the budget. An asset register is held by the Equipment Manager, and the camera is covered by a one-year warranty.
Framing on full-size pitches	Recommended 4 m mounting height at the halfway line, tested during the pilot. Clubs are offered a free sample clip before they buy, so nobody pays for footage they can't use.
Footage loss	Offloaded the same night, copy checked before the card is cleared, and a spare memory card carried on match days.
Battery on long match days	About 4 hours per charge, plus a power bank in the budget for back-to-back age-group games.
Low uptake by clubs or parents	The programme's main value is coaching our own players, which doesn't depend on sales. Running costs are low enough (R4,800 a year) to be covered by one sponsor or a few filming jobs.
Volunteer capacity	The camera runs itself, so setup takes about 10 minutes. Hand-edited reels are limited to what coaches can manage. External filming jobs pay a stipend to a trained parent or youth volunteer.
Clashing fixtures	One camera can't cover games at two venues. Priority rotates fairly between age groups, published per term. A second camera is the first use of the upgrade fund.

11 Implementation plan

WHEN	MILESTONE
Month 0	Funding agreed. Formal quote from the SA retailer. Information Officer registration confirmed. Footage Sharing Agreement, consent register, order register and updated consent wording finalised.
Month 1	Equipment purchased and insured. Coaches trained on setup, the app and offloading. Cloud folder set up. GDFL informed. Consent refreshed for all registered players.
Months 1–2	Internal pilot: all Growfit matches filmed and used in training. Camera position tested on each pitch size. No sales during the pilot.
Month 3	Club footage service and parent highlight packages launched. Sponsor approached.
School holidays	Tournament filming offered to schools and organisers.
Month 9	Review against KPIs. Decide on the use of the upgrade fund (second camera or upgrade).

12 What we will report

Growfit will send the funder a short report each quarter, with an annual summary.

≥ 80%

of Growfit league matches filmed

≥ 2

video review sessions per squad per month

100%

of shared footage covered by consent or a signed agreement

≥ R30k

net service income per year (base case)

We will also report qualitatively: players who moved to higher-level teams, school sports programmes or trials using their reels, and feedback from coaches, parents and partner clubs.

13 The request

Growfit Sports Academy NPC requests **R29,700** as a **grant or sponsorship** to establish the Growfit Match Video Programme with an XbotGo Falcon AI camera. Growfit is a non-profit company with no shareholders, so it cannot offer equity. An interest-free loan repayable from service income can be discussed. The funder will be credited on all programme material unless they ask otherwise.

For Growfit Sports Academy NPC

Name: _____

Role: Academy Director

Date: ____ / ____ / 2026

For the Funding Partner

Name: _____

Organisation: _____

Date: ____ / ____ / 2026

A Sources & notes

- XbotGo Falcon product and pricing: <https://xbotgo.com/products/xbotgo-falcon-true-4k-ai-camera-for-team-sports>
- South African retailer (R15,400–R21,000 depending on pack): <https://amazeballs.co.za/shop/xbotgo/xbotgo-falcon-4k-ai-camera-elite-pack/>
- Elite Pack contents and NT4 tripod: <https://xb2025.zendesk.com/hc/en-us/articles/4926541068574>
- Recommended shooting positions and heights: <https://xb2025.zendesk.com/hc/en-us/articles/5022106076062>
- No subscription required: <https://xb2025.zendesk.com/hc/en-us/articles/4926385472030>
- Independent reviews: <https://sportssteps.com/xbotgo-falcon-review-worth-it-filming-kids-games/> · <https://soccerstories.net/xbotgo-falcon-user-review/> · <https://www.androidpolice.com/xbotgo-falcon-dual-lens-ai-camera/>
- POPIA (Act 4 of 2013), sections 34–35; Children's Act 38 of 2005.

Calculations: club footage = matches per month × purchase rate × price × 9 months; highlights = term packages × R300 × 3 terms + season reels × R800; filming = jobs per month × R900 × 9 + tournament days × R2,500; stipends R150 per job and R300 per tournament day. Figures rounded to the nearest R100.